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QUESTION 26

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: When conservationists reintroduced beavers to a stretch of Scottish river in 2009, they expected the dams to slow the water so much that migrating salmon would struggle to move upstream. Monitoring over the next decade showed something different. Salmon passed the dams easily during high flows, and the deep pools behind the dams turned out to shelter young salmon during dry summers. The team now describes its original prediction as reasonable but mistaken.

According to the text, what did monitoring reveal about the effect of beaver dams on salmon?

A: The dams blocked salmon from moving upstream, as the team had predicted.

B: The dams did not block salmon, and the pools behind them sheltered young fish.

C: The dams slowed the water so much that dry summers became more dangerous for salmon.

D: The dams had no measurable effect of any kind on the salmon population.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The team expected the dams to block salmon, but monitoring showed salmon passed during high flows and the pools helped young fish. D is too strong, since the passage does describe an effect. Trick: when a passage says a prediction was mistaken, the answer is what actually happened, never the prediction. Hunt for the words "expected" and "turned out."

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 27

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Sourdough bread rises because wild yeast in the starter produces carbon dioxide. Baker Ines Duarte notes that yeast alone will not produce a good loaf. Without gluten, the network of proteins that forms when flour and water are worked together, the gas escapes and the dough stays flat. Gluten does not create the gas; it traps it. A loaf needs both, Duarte says, and bakers who blame a flat loaf on weak starter are often mistaken.

According to the text, what role does gluten play in the rising of sourdough bread?

A: It produces the carbon dioxide that makes the dough expand.

B: It replaces the wild yeast in starters that have grown weak.

C: It slows the yeast so that the dough rises more evenly.

D: It holds in the gas that the yeast produces.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The passage says plainly that gluten does not create the gas, it traps it. A gives gluten the yeast's job. Trick: when a passage says "X does not do this, it does that," the answer is the second half. Circle the word "not" and read forward.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 28

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: For years, two explanations competed for why the Sahara turned from grassland to desert around 5,000 years ago. One held that a slow shift in the Earth's orbit dried the region gradually. The other held that herds of livestock stripped the vegetation and triggered a sudden collapse. Sediment cores published in 2017 show the change unfolding over roughly a thousand years, with no abrupt break. Researchers say the cores are hard to square with the sudden-collapse account.

According to the text, what do the sediment cores indicate?

A: The change was gradual, which is difficult to reconcile with the sudden-collapse explanation.

B: The change was abrupt, which supports the livestock explanation.

C: Livestock played no part in the region's vegetation at any point.

D: The Earth's orbit did not shift during the period in question.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The cores show change over about a thousand years with no abrupt break, which is why researchers say the sudden-collapse account is hard to square with them. C and D claim far more than the passage does. Trick: evidence against one explanation is not proof that the other cause never existed. Keep your answer as small as the passage.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 29

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: A city bike-share program reported that trips beginning at suburban stations made up 12 percent of all rides in 2015 and 9 percent in 2023. Program director Vikram Rao cautions against reading this as a decline in suburban use. Total ridership more than tripled over the same period, so the number of suburban trips actually rose from about 60,000 a year to roughly 140,000. The suburban share fell only because downtown ridership grew faster.

According to the text, what happened to the number of suburban trips between 2015 and 2023?

A: It fell from 12 percent to 9 percent of all trips taken.

B: It stayed roughly level while downtown ridership tripled.

C: It rose from about 60,000 a year to roughly 140,000.

D: It fell by about 3 percent each year across the period.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The share fell but the count rose, from about 60,000 to about 140,000. A answers with the share when the question asked for the number. Trick: a falling percentage can hide a rising total. Check whether the question says "share" or "number," then take the matching figure.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 30

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In her survey of urban planning, Dalia Haddad notes that most textbooks still describe the highway-building boom of the 1960s as a straightforward response to rising car ownership. Haddad reports this view without endorsing it. Her own reading of city budget records suggests the highways were planned years before car ownership climbed, and that the roads helped cause the rise in ownership rather than following it.

According to the text, which view does Haddad herself hold?

A: The highways were planned before car ownership rose and helped cause it.

B: The highways were a straightforward response to rising car ownership.

C: Textbooks have generally described the boom accurately.

D: Car ownership had no relationship to highway construction in the 1960s.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The passage says Haddad reports the textbook view without endorsing it, and that her own reading is the opposite. B is the textbook view, not hers. Trick: "reports without endorsing" means the idea is not the author's. Find the words "her own" or "she argues" and take only what follows.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 31

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The monarch butterfly is famous for migrating thousands of kilometers between Canada and central Mexico. Biologist Nadia Perez points out that this describes only the eastern North American population. Monarchs in southern Florida, Hawaii, and parts of Australia are year-round residents that do not migrate at all, and a smaller western population winters along the California coast rather than in Mexico. Migration, Perez writes, is a habit of certain monarch populations, not a fixed trait of the species.

According to the text, what does Perez say about monarch migration?

A: All monarchs migrate, though the distances vary widely by region.

B: Migration belongs to some monarch populations rather than to the species as a whole.

C: Monarchs in Hawaii migrate to California rather than to Mexico.

D: The western population has recently stopped migrating altogether.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Perez says migration belongs to certain populations, not to the species, and she names groups that do not migrate at all. Trick: watch for a passage that narrows a famous fact from "all" to "some." The answer usually contains a word like some, certain, or particular.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 32

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: When the Netherlands lowered the daytime speed limit on its motorways from 130 to 100 kilometers per hour in 2020, transport analysts tracked several outcomes. Average journey times on the affected routes lengthened by two to three minutes. Nitrogen emissions along the corridors fell measurably. The number of vehicles using the motorways, however, was essentially unchanged, since drivers who might have switched to other roads found those routes no faster.

According to the text, which outcome did not change after the speed limit was lowered?

A: Average journey times on the affected routes.

B: Nitrogen emissions along the motorway corridors.

C: The speed of motorways relative to other roads.

D: The number of vehicles using the motorways.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Journey times lengthened and emissions fell, but the passage says vehicle numbers were essentially unchanged. Trick: for a "which did not change" question, cross out every item the passage reports a change for. Whatever is left standing is the answer.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 33

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Of the eight planets in the solar system, seven rotate on their axes in the same direction as they orbit the Sun. Venus is the exception: it turns slowly in the opposite direction, so that on Venus the Sun rises in the west. Uranus is sometimes offered as a third case because it is tipped almost onto its side, but its rotation still runs in the standard direction relative to its own extreme tilt.

According to the text, what makes Venus unusual among the planets?

A: It is tipped so far onto its side that its poles face the Sun.

B: It rotates far more slowly than any other planet in the solar system.

C: It rotates in the direction opposite to the one in which it orbits.

D: It is the only planet on which the Sun is visible from the surface.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The passage calls Venus the exception because it turns in the opposite direction, which is why the Sun rises in the west there. A describes Uranus. Trick: when a passage names one item as "the exception," the reason sits immediately after the colon. Do not borrow a detail from the item mentioned next.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 34
SECTION: READING_WRITING
CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail
DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Nutrition researcher Ola Bergstrom tested whether replacing white rice with barley at a single daily meal changed blood sugar responses in 240 adults over eight weeks. It did: glucose peaks after the meal were lower in the barley group. Bergstrom emphasizes the limits of the design. Participants were all between 30 and 45 years old, none had diabetes, and the study measured glucose responses rather than long-term health outcomes such as heart disease.

According to the text, what did Bergstrom's study not measure?

A: Blood sugar responses after meals containing barley.

B: The effect of barley in adults between 30 and 45.

C: The difference between barley and white rice at one daily meal.

D: Long-term health outcomes such as heart disease.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The last sentence says the study measured glucose responses rather than long-term outcomes such as heart disease. A, B, and C are all things it did measure. Trick: the phrase "rather than" separates what was studied from what was not. The answer to a "did not measure" question sits right after it.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 35

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Between 1990 and 2020, global carbon dioxide emissions from aviation roughly doubled. Over the same period, the fuel burned per passenger kilometer fell by more than half, as engines and aircraft designs improved. Analyst Bo Feng explains that the two figures are not in conflict: efficiency per passenger improved steadily, but the number of passenger kilometers flown grew faster still, so the total kept climbing.

According to the text, what happened to fuel use per passenger kilometer between 1990 and 2020?

A: It fell by more than half, even as total emissions rose.

B: It roughly doubled, in line with the rise in total emissions.

C: It stayed flat while the number of passengers grew.

D: It fell slightly, which is why total emissions grew only modestly.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The passage reports two different measures. Per passenger kilometer, fuel use fell by more than half. In total, emissions doubled because far more kilometers were flown. Trick: when a passage gives both a "per unit" figure and a total, match your answer to the exact unit named in the question.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 36

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Sleep researcher Ingrid Haugen found that students who kept consistent bedtimes earned higher grades than students whose sleep schedules varied widely. Haugen acknowledges an obvious alternative reading: conscientious students may both keep regular hours and study harder, so the schedule may be a symptom rather than a cause. She answers this by noting that the grade gap persisted even among students matched for hours studied, though she stops short of calling the evidence conclusive.

According to the text, how does Haugen respond to the alternative reading of her results?

A: She rejects it on the grounds that conscientiousness cannot be measured.

B: She accepts it and withdraws her original claim about bedtimes.

C: She notes that the grade gap remained among students who studied the same number of hours.

D: She argues that her evidence settles the question conclusively.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Haugen answers the objection by pointing out that the gap survived when study hours were matched, and the passage adds that she still does not call it conclusive, so D is out. Trick: when a passage raises an objection, the reply is usually the very next sentence. Read one sentence past the objection.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 37

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: When streaming services began commissioning original films, the average running time of their releases was noticeably shorter than that of studio features. Film economist Marta Kaminski shows that this held true through about 2016. From 2017 onward the pattern inverted: streaming originals grew longer year by year while studio releases held steady, and by 2023 the streaming average exceeded the studio average by eleven minutes.

According to the text, what does Kaminski show about streaming film lengths after 2017?

A: They continued to fall further behind studio running times.

B: They rose year by year and eventually passed studio running times.

C: They held steady while studio running times grew longer.

D: They matched studio running times exactly by 2023.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The passage says the pattern inverted after 2017, with streaming films growing longer and finally exceeding studio films by eleven minutes. Trick: a word like inverted, reversed, or flipped means the earlier trend no longer describes the later period. Answer from the later period only.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 38

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Hydrologist Kenji Abe modeled what would happen to the Rio Grande if snowpack in the southern Rockies fell another 20 percent. Under that scenario his model projects that flows past El Paso would drop below the level guaranteed by treaty in roughly one year in three. Abe is explicit that snowpack has not yet fallen that far and that current flows still meet the treaty level in most years. The model, he says, describes a plausible future rather than the present.

According to the text, what is the current state of flows past El Paso?

A: They still meet the treaty level in most years.

B: They fall below the treaty level in roughly one year in three.

C: They have already dropped by 20 percent.

D: They are no longer measured against the treaty level.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The passage says snowpack has not yet fallen that far and that current flows still meet the treaty level in most years. B is the modeled future, not the present. Trick: words like would, projects, and scenario describe something that has not happened. Match your answer to the time period the question asks about.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 39

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: A modern hearing aid contains three linked parts. The microphone converts sound in the room into an electrical signal. The processor, a small computer, filters that signal, boosting the frequencies the wearer has trouble hearing and suppressing steady background noise. The receiver then converts the processed signal back into sound inside the ear canal. Audiologist Ravi Menon notes that most complaints about hearing aids concern the processor's settings rather than any failure of the other two parts.

According to the text, which part of a hearing aid suppresses background noise?

A: The microphone, which converts room sound into an electrical signal.

B: The receiver, which converts the signal back into sound in the ear canal.

C: The ear canal, which naturally damps steady sounds.

D: The processor, which boosts some frequencies and suppresses steady noise.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The passage gives each part one job, and suppressing steady background noise belongs to the processor. The microphone only converts sound into a signal and the receiver converts it back. Trick: for a system with three parts, write each part with its single job in a short list before you read the options.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 40

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Volcanologist Sigrun Palsdottir studies lava flows that threaten inhabited areas. Diverting a flow with earth barriers or seawater cooling has succeeded a handful of times, most famously at Heimaey in 1973, but Palsdottir stresses that such efforts rarely work and are almost never attempted on large flows. She adds that the Heimaey operation is often described as a routine technique, which she considers a misreading of a single unusual success.

According to the text, what does Palsdottir say about attempts to divert lava flows?

A: They have never succeeded outside of laboratory conditions.

B: They have occasionally succeeded but seldom work and are rarely tried on large flows.

C: They are now a routine part of volcanic emergency response.

D: They failed at Heimaey in 1973 despite extensive effort.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The passage says diversion has succeeded a handful of times, including at Heimaey, but rarely works. A says never, which is too strong, and C is the misreading she rejects. Trick: rarely is not never, and a handful of times is not none. Match the strength of the word exactly.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 41

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: A soil bacterium that breaks down polyethylene has attracted attention as a possible answer to plastic waste. In controlled tanks held at a steady 30 degrees Celsius, the bacterium reduced the mass of plastic film by about 20 percent in six weeks. Microbiologist Teodora Ilic reports that the same strain, released into test plots of ordinary soil, degraded less than 2 percent over the same period, since temperatures fluctuated and competing microbes crowded it out.

According to the text, what happened when the bacterium was tested in ordinary soil?

A: It degraded plastic film at roughly the same rate as in the tanks.

B: It failed to survive outside controlled conditions.

C: It degraded far less plastic than it had in the tanks.

D: It degraded plastic faster once competing microbes were present.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: In tanks the bacterium removed about 20 percent of the film, but in soil it managed under 2 percent. B is too strong, since it still degraded some plastic and so was alive. Trick: when a passage gives one result in the lab and one in the field, the question almost always wants the weaker field result.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 42

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Ecologist Paulo Ferreira traced the collapse of a kelp forest off the California coast. A marine disease killed most of the region's sunflower sea stars. With their main predator gone, sea urchin numbers exploded. The urchins then grazed the kelp down to bare rock. Ferreira emphasizes that the disease did not touch the kelp itself and that its effect ran entirely through the urchins.

According to the text, what directly caused the loss of the kelp?

A: The marine disease, which killed the kelp along with the sea stars.

B: Grazing by sea urchins, whose numbers had risen.

C: The disappearance of sunflower sea stars from the reef.

D: A change in ocean temperature that weakened the kelp.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The chain runs disease, then fewer sea stars, then more urchins, then grazed kelp. The step that touches the kelp is the urchins' grazing, and the passage says the disease never touched the kelp itself. Trick: for a "directly caused" question, take the last step in the chain, the one that actually touches the thing named in the question.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 43

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In a life-cycle comparison of three shopping bags, researchers counted how many uses each needed before its total environmental cost fell below that of a single-use plastic bag. A paper bag needed about three uses. A conventional cotton tote needed roughly 130. An organic cotton tote, whose lower-yield farming demands more land and water, needed close to 150. The researchers note that any bag reused indefinitely eventually wins, whatever its type.

According to the text, which bag required the greatest number of uses before its cost fell below that of a single-use plastic bag?

A: The organic cotton tote.

B: The conventional cotton tote.

C: The paper bag.

D: All three required about the same number of uses.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The three figures are about three uses for paper, roughly 130 for conventional cotton, and close to 150 for organic cotton, so organic cotton is highest. Trick: when three numbers appear, write them in a column beside their names and answer from the column. Do not pick whichever option sounds most environmentally friendly.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 44

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Paleontologists once sorted a small feathered fossil from northeastern China into a genus called Archaeoraptor, a name published in 1999. Within a year the specimen behind it was shown to be a composite, its front half from one animal and its tail from another. The name Archaeoraptor was withdrawn and the two halves were reassigned: the body to Yanornis, a bird already described in 1999, and the tail to a newly named dromaeosaur, Microraptor. Curator Wen Zhao notes that Microraptor, born from a discredited fossil, is now among the best-studied dinosaurs of its kind.

According to the text, what became of the tail portion of the Archaeoraptor specimen?

A: It was shown to belong to Yanornis, a bird described in 1999.

B: It was discarded along with the withdrawn name Archaeoraptor.

C: It was found to be a modern forgery rather than a fossil.

D: It was assigned to a newly named dromaeosaur, Microraptor.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The passage splits the specimen in two: the body went to Yanornis and the tail to the new genus Microraptor. A gives the tail the body's outcome. Trick: when a passage divides one thing into two parts, tag each part with its own outcome before reading the options.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 45

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Linguist Sofia Novak argues that a set of words shared by Basque and the ancient Iberian inscriptions reflects contact between the two languages rather than common descent. She sets out what would settle the matter. Shared basic vocabulary, such as words for body parts and numerals, would point to descent, since such words are rarely borrowed. Shared terms for trade goods and metals would point instead to contact. The overlap Novak documents falls almost entirely into the second category, though she notes that the sample is small.

According to the text, what kind of shared vocabulary would indicate common descent rather than contact?

A: Words for trade goods, of the kind Novak documents.

B: Words for metals and the tools used to work them.

C: Basic vocabulary, such as words for body parts and numerals.

D: Any vocabulary at all shared by two neighboring languages.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Novak sets up a test with two branches. Basic vocabulary such as body parts and numerals would mean descent, while trade words would mean contact. The question asks about descent, so take the first branch. Trick: when a passage says "X would show this, Y would show that," match the question to the correct branch before reading the options.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 46

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Psychologist Nils Ostberg tested whether the calming effect of walking in a forest comes from the greenery or from the absence of traffic noise. Participants walked in a forest, along a quiet residential street, and beside a busy road, with stress hormones measured afterward. The forest and the quiet street produced almost identical reductions, while the busy road produced none. Ostberg concludes that the quiet, not the vegetation, is doing most of the work, though he allows that longer exposures might yet reveal an effect of greenery.

According to the text, what does the quiet-street condition allow Ostberg to conclude?

A: That the reduction in stress does not depend mainly on the presence of vegetation.

B: That vegetation and quiet contribute equally to the reduction in stress.

C: That traffic noise has no measurable effect on stress hormones.

D: That longer walks in the forest would produce larger reductions.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The quiet street had no forest yet gave nearly the same result, so greenery cannot be doing most of the work. D is only something Ostberg allows might be true. Trick: a control condition exists to remove one ingredient. Ask which ingredient it is missing, and the answer will be about that ingredient.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 47

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: A review of clinical trial registrations found that 62 percent of trials begun in a five-year window eventually published results. Among the trials that did publish, 38 percent appeared more than two years after the trial ended. Epidemiologist Hana Cerny stresses that this second figure describes only the publishing group. Expressed as a share of all registered trials, late publications account for roughly 24 percent, while the remaining 38 percent of registered trials produced no publication at all.

According to the text, what does the second figure of 38 percent describe?

A: The share of all registered trials that were never published.

B: The share of all registered trials published more than two years late.

C: The share of published trials that appeared more than two years after the trial ended.

D: The share of registered trials that published results within two years.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The passage says the figure describes only the group that published. As a share of all trials the late figure is about 24 percent, and the number 38 shows up again for unpublished trials, which is exactly the confusion the passage warns about. Trick: for any percentage, find the words "of" or "among" beside it. They tell you what the percentage is a slice of.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 48

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Two agreements are often confused. The Montreal Protocol, adopted in 1987, phased out chlorofluorocarbons in order to protect the ozone layer, and the substitutes it encouraged, hydrofluorocarbons, turned out to be potent greenhouse gases. The Kigali Amendment of 2016 amends the Montreal Protocol in order to phase those substitutes down. Climate lawyer Aisha Bello notes that the Kigali Amendment therefore sits inside an ozone treaty while doing climate work, which is why its emissions cuts are not counted under the Paris Agreement.

According to the text, what is the purpose of the Kigali Amendment?

A: To phase out chlorofluorocarbons in order to protect the ozone layer.

B: To phase down hydrofluorocarbons, the substitutes encouraged by the Montreal Protocol.

C: To bring ozone-related emissions cuts under the Paris Agreement.

D: To replace the Montreal Protocol with a treaty focused on climate.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Kigali amends the Montreal Protocol and targets hydrofluorocarbons, the substitutes. A is the original Montreal Protocol's job, and D is wrong because amending a treaty is not replacing it. Trick: when a passage names two agreements, write each name beside its one target chemical. Wrong answers trade the targets.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 49

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: A widely cited finding holds that people who volunteer live longer than people who do not. Sociologist Miguel Arroyo points out that the strongest version of this result comes from a study of retirees aged 65 and over who were already in good health when they enrolled. Adults in poor health were underrepresented, since illness both prevents volunteering and shortens life. When Arroyo repeated the analysis with participants at all health levels included, the survival advantage shrank by more than half.

According to the text, what was true of the participants in the study Arroyo criticizes?

A: They were drawn from every age group and every health level.

B: They were selected because they had already volunteered for many years.

C: They were younger on average than the participants in Arroyo's reanalysis.

D: They were retirees aged 65 and over who were in good health at enrollment.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The passage describes the sample directly as retirees aged 65 and over already in good health, with sick adults underrepresented. Trick: when a passage questions a finding, look at who was in the sample. The answer is often a plain description of the group rather than a claim about the result.

END QUESTION

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QUESTION 50

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Detail

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Antikythera mechanism, recovered from a Roman-era shipwreck, is a geared device that tracked the positions of the sun and moon and predicted eclipses. Historian Lucas Fenn writes that its gear ratios have now been worked out in detail and its astronomical functions largely reconstructed. What remains unsettled, he says, is where such a device came from: no comparable geared object survives from the following thousand years, and no ancient text describes a workshop capable of making one. The gaps in the record, not the gaps in the machine, are the problem.

According to the text, what aspect of the Antikythera mechanism does Fenn describe as still unsettled?

A: The way its gear ratios were arranged.

B: Whether it was capable of predicting eclipses.

C: Where and by whom such a device could have been produced.

D: Whether the shipwreck it came from dates to the Roman era.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Fenn says the gears and functions are largely worked out and that what remains unsettled is where the device came from, since no workshop is recorded anywhere. Trick: find the phrase "what remains" or "still unsettled" and take the words after it. Everything before it is the solved part.

END QUESTION